Girls Flag Football — AZ Launch & Nike Partnership

Master Project Plan & Roadmap

Date: 2026-02-19 | **Prepared by:** TPM Agent | **Client:** Program Founder **Horizon:** Zero to One — February 2026 through June 2027

Mission

Build a girls-first flag football organization in Arizona, grow it to 250+ registered players, establish it as the defining brand for girls' flag football, and execute a Nike brand partnership — then replicate nationally.

The Zero-to-One Framework

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ZERO                                        ONE
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No entity    → Legal entity + 501(c)(3) filing
No brand     → Named, trademarked, Nike-ready brand
No web       → Live website + registration platform
No players   → 250+ registered girls in AZ
No partners  → USA Flag Football + NFL Flag + AZ Cardinals affiliations
No sponsor   → Nike deal signed ($25K–$100K Year 1)
No team      → Certified coaching staff + operational team
No media     → Local press + 10K+ social media following
No proof     → Season 1 impact report + data package
No expansion → National model ready for TX, CA, FL launch
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Program Roadmap — Visual Timeline

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2026                                                          2027
FEB  MAR  APR  MAY  JUN  JUL  AUG  SEP  OCT  NOV  DEC  JAN  FEB  MAR  APR  MAY  JUN
 │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │    │
 ├────┴────┤
 │PHASE 1  │  Foundation & Brand
 │         │  Legal · Brand · Website · Social · Governing Body Affiliation
 └─────────┘
      │         ├──────────────────────┤
      │         │   PHASE 2            │  Arizona Market Launch
      │         │   Players · Coaches  │  School Districts · Season 1
      │         └──────────────────────┘
      │                   │    ├──────────────────────┤
      │                   │    │     PHASE 3          │  Nike Partnership Pursuit
      │                   │    │     Pitch · Negotiate│  Term Sheet · Sign
      │                   │    └──────────────────────┘
      │                   │               │    ├──────────────┤
      │                   │               │    │  PHASE 4     │  Traction & Proof
      │                   │               │    │  250 players │  Impact Report
      │                   │               │    └──────────────┘
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      │                   │               │           │         ├──────────────┤
      │                   │               │           │         │   PHASE 5    │
      │                   │               │           │         │  National    │
      │                   │               │           │         │  TX Launch   │
      │                   │               │           │         │  1,000 Girls │
      │                   │               │           │         └──────────────┘
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Phase 1: Foundation & Brand

Duration: February 19 – April 30, 2026 (10 weeks) **Goal:** Everything needed to exist as a real organization

Week 1–2: Legal & Structure

- [ ] Decide: LLC or 501(c)(3) nonprofit (recommendation: 501(c)(3) — unlocks grant funding and Nike's community grant programs)
- [ ] File Articles of Incorporation in Arizona
- [ ] Apply for Federal EIN (same-day online)
- [ ] Open business bank account
- [ ] Engage sports/nonprofit attorney for 501(c)(3) filing and trademark

Week 2–4: Brand Identity

- [ ] Name finalization (conduct trademark search before committing)
- [ ] Logo + brand guide (colors, fonts, imagery style)
- [ ] Mission statement and tagline locked
- [ ] Brand brief prepared (needed for website, social, and Nike pitch)

Week 4–6: Website & Digital

- [ ] Platform decision: **Recommend Webflow** for Year 1 (professional, no-code manageable, sponsor-ready presentation)
- [ ] Website pages: Home, About/Mission, Programs, Register Interest, Sponsors, News, Contact, Donate
- [ ] Registration interest capture form (Mailchimp or HubSpot Free)
- [ ] Domain registered, SSL active, analytics installed (Google Analytics 4)

Week 4–6: Social Media

- [ ] Instagram — @[brand]_flag (primary platform for teen/youth audience)
- [ ] TikTok — @[brand]_flag (fastest growth platform for this demographic)
- [ ] YouTube — @[brand]Flag (highlight reels, coach spotlights)
- [ ] First 90-day content calendar drafted
- [ ] Social media voice guide aligned with brand

Week 5–7: Governing Body Affiliation

- [ ] USA Flag Football chapter application filed
- [ ] NFL Flag inquiry submitted (girls chapter in AZ)
- [ ] Arizona Cardinals community partnership outreach initiated

Phase 1 Exit Criteria

- [ ] Legal entity active with EIN and bank account
- [ ] Brand fully designed and trademarked
- [ ] Website live with registration interest capture
- [ ] Social media channels launched with 10+ posts
- [ ] USA Flag Football affiliation confirmed
- [ ] 3+ institutional relationships in motion

Phase 1 Budget: $15,000–$25,000

Item	Estimate
Legal (entity + trademark)	$3,000–$5,000
Brand design	$3,000–$6,000
Website (Webflow + setup)	$2,000–$4,000
Domain, hosting, tools (12 mo)	$500–$1,000
Marketing materials (print + digital)	$1,000–$2,000
USA Flag Football affiliation fee	$200–$500
Travel/outreach	$1,000–$2,000
Contingency (15%)	$1,500–$3,000

Phase 2: Arizona Market Launch

Duration: May – September 2026 (5 months) **Goal:** 100+ registered girls, first season completed, content engine running

May–June: Infrastructure

- [ ] School district MOU execution — Target: 3 AZ districts (Phoenix, Scottsdale, Tempe)
- [ ] Field access agreements secured (parks, schools, community centers)
- [ ] Youth sports liability insurance active (via USA Flag Football or separate policy)
- [ ] Coaching recruitment: 1 Head Coach + 4 assistants
- [ ] All coaches: USA Flag Football certified + background checked
- [ ] Equipment procurement: flags, balls, cones, practice jerseys

June–July: Registration & Launch

- [ ] Season 1 registration opens (online via website)
- [ ] Target: 50 registered by June 30 / 100 by September 30
- [ ] Age groups: 8–10, 11–13, 14–18
- [ ] Registration fee: $75–$150 (sliding scale with scholarship fund)
- [ ] Free registration partnership with school districts for underserved schools

July–September: Season 1

- [ ] Season 1: 8-week practice + 4-game schedule

- [ ] Mandatory content capture at every session (video + photo)
- [ ] Parent volunteer program established
- [ ] Weekly social media content from all sessions
- [ ] Local media outreach: AZ Republic, 12News, AZFamily (ABC15)
- [ ] First showcase/game event with AZ Cardinals co-branding (if partnership secured)

Phase 2 Budget: $60,000–$90,000

Item	Estimate
Head Coach (part-time, 5 months)	$15,000–$20,000
Assistant Coaches x4 (part-time)	$12,000–$16,000
Equipment (flags, balls, jerseys)	$8,000–$12,000
Insurance (participant + liability)	$3,000–$5,000
Field fees / permits	$2,000–$4,000
Marketing / paid social	$5,000–$8,000
Events / showcase	$3,000–$6,000
Operations / admin	$5,000–$8,000
Contingency	$7,000–$11,000

Revenue Offsets (Phase 2):

Source	Estimate
Player registration fees (100 players × $100 avg)	$10,000
Local sponsor #1	$10,000–$25,000
NFL Foundation Youth Football Grant	$5,000–$25,000
Women's Sports Foundation Grant	$5,000–$15,000
Net burn	**~$20,000–$45,000**

Phase 3: Nike Partnership Pursuit

Duration: June – November 2026 (concurrent with Phase 2/4) **Goal:** Signed Nike sponsorship agreement — Year 1 deal

The Nike Approach Strategy

Nike does not respond well to cold outreach from unknown organizations. The path to a Nike deal is through proof, warm introductions, and alignment with Nike's existing programs.

Three Entry Points — Pursue all simultaneously:

Entry Point A: NFL Flag → Nike NFL Flag is the NFL's official youth flag football program. Nike is the NFL's official uniform supplier. This is the cleanest warm path. Secure an NFL Flag girls chapter affiliation → request NFL Flag to introduce you to their Nike contacts.

Entry Point B: Nike Community Impact Fund Nike has a formal community grant program. Applications open periodically. A girls' flag football program with 100+ players, school district partnerships, and a Title IX alignment story is a strong candidate. Grant range: $10,000–$100,000.

Entry Point C: Nike AZ Territory Manager Nike assigns regional territory managers for community and grassroots sports partnerships. The AZ territory manager handles smaller-scale local deals. This is faster than HQ but requires a warm intro. Path: through AZ Cardinals community team or local Nike retailer relationships.

Nike Pitch Deck — Required Sections

1. **The Problem** — Girls are underrepresented in organized football. 40% of youth sports participants are girls; less than 8% play football variants.
2. **The Mission** — A girls-first flag football organization that builds confidence, athletic competence, and community.
3. **The Traction** — X players registered, Y school districts, Z media mentions, A social following.
4. **The Brand Story** — Show the brand. Show the girls. Show the moments. Nike buys emotion and culture.
5. **The National Vision** — AZ is the proof of concept. Next: TX, CA, FL. Total addressable market in 3 years: 10,000+ girls.
6. **The Ask** — See sponsorship structure below.
7. **The ROI for Nike** — Association with fastest-growing girls' sport, Title IX alignment, NFL co-brand halo, social content rights.

Nike Sponsorship Ask — Year 1

Tier 1 Ask (Minimum Viable Deal):

- $25,000–$50,000 in Nike product (uniforms, cleats, training gear, balls)
- Nike logo on all uniforms and website
- Co-marketing rights for Nike to use content from our events
- Annual review with option to upgrade

Tier 2 Ask (Preferred Deal):

- $50,000 Nike product + $25,000 cash
- Naming rights to Season championship event
- Nike athlete ambassador (1 local AZ female athlete) for one season
- Social media co-posts (Nike Girls in Sport channel)

What Nike Gets:

- 100–250 girls wearing Nike gear in AZ (visible, photographable, shareable)
- Content rights for Nike social/marketing use
- Community impact story aligned with Nike's "Girls in Sport" and "Sport Changes Everything" campaigns
- First mover position in the fastest-growing girls' sport
- National expansion commitment — deal grows with the program

Negotiation Guidance

- **Never lead with cash ask.** Lead with product. Product is low-cost for Nike and high-value for you.

- **Proof beats pitch.** Walk in with a full season impact report, player photos/video, and media clips. Nike's team needs to bring something back to their team.
- **Exclusivity is your leverage.** You have not yet signed Under Armour or Adidas. Offer category exclusivity (footwear, apparel) in exchange for a better deal.
- **Tie to NFL Flag.** If you have NFL Flag affiliation, Nike is already on the table as a supplier. Make the connection explicit.
- **Build FOMO.** If you have even a conversation with Under Armour, mention it (not threateningly — just factually). Nike responds to competitive urgency.
- **Start local, scale terms.** Year 1 deal with year 2/3 escalation terms written in (e.g., if national registration reaches 1,000, product allocation doubles).

Phase 4: Traction & Proof

Duration: September – December 2026 **Goal:** 250 registered AZ girls, Season 1 impact report, national model ready

- Season 1 wrap report: impact data, demographic breakdown, media mentions, testimonials
- Season 2 registration opens with Nike gear (if deal signed)
- National expansion model finalized: franchise, chapter, or direct-operated
- Nike relationship active: first product shipment received, co-content captured
- Additional sponsors approached: Gatorade, AZ corporate brands, healthcare systems

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Phase 5: National Expansion

Duration: January – June 2027 **Goal:** First national expansion state launched, 1,000 total girls registered

- Target state: **Texas** (largest girls youth sports market, strong football culture)
- Secondary target: **California** (largest population, strong Nike presence)
- Expansion model: Certified chapter director program
- Nike deal expanded: national tier conversation triggered at 1,000 registered

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Key Metrics — North Star Dashboard

Metric	Phase 1 Target	Phase 2 Target	Phase 3 Target	National Target
Registered Girls (AZ)	0 (interest list)	100	250	500
Registered Girls (National)	—	—	—	1,000
School District Partners	0	3	5	20
Social Media Followers	500	5,000	10,000	50,000
Media Mentions	0	3	10	50+
Sponsor Deals	0	1 local	Nike (Year 1)	Nike national + 2 others

Coaches Certified	0	5	10	50
Annual Revenue	$0	$25K	$100K	$500K+

Total Budget — Zero to One (18 months)

Phase	Budget
Phase 1: Foundation	$15,000–$25,000
Phase 2: AZ Launch	$60,000–$90,000
Phase 3: Nike Pursuit (marketing/legal)	$10,000–$20,000
Phase 4: Traction	$30,000–$50,000
Phase 5: National Expansion (seed)	$50,000–$80,000
Total 18-Month Investment	**$165,000–$265,000**

Funding Strategy:

- Founder/angel investment: $50,000–$100,000 (bridge)
- Grants (NFL Foundation, Women's Sports Foundation, Title IX advocacy grants): $30,000–$75,000
- Local AZ sponsors (Year 1): $25,000–$75,000
- Player registration fees: $15,000–$30,000
- Nike deal (Year 1): $25,000–$75,000 product value (reduces cash need)
- Merchandise: $10,000–$20,000

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